API DOCUMENTATION

YGOPRODeck REST API Specification (v7)

Official integration guide, request protocols, rate limit specifications, and primary query parameters for the Yu-Gi-Oh! card database.

20 req/s	1 Hour	2 Days	HTTP GET
RATE LIMIT	THROTTLE BAN	CACHE TTL	ACCESS METHOD

Compliance Rule: Direct image hotlinking from YGOPRODeck servers is strictly prohibited. Clients must store pulled card details and images locally to conserve bandwidth. Exceeding 20 requests per second will trigger an automatic 1-hour IP block.

1. OVERVIEW & CORE ENDPOINTS

Base URL: `https://db.ygoprodeck.com/api/v7/`. All endpoints accept HTTP GET requests and return structured JSON objects.

METHOD	ENDPOINT PATH	DESCRIPTION & BEHAVIOR
GET	`/cardinfo.php`	Main catalog endpoint. Returns cards matching comprehensive query filters. Cached for 2 days.
GET	`/randomcard.php`	Returns a single random card. No parameters permitted. Cache-Control is disabled.
GET	`/cardsets.php`	Returns all known set names, set codes, total card counts, and TCG release dates.
GET	`/cardsetsinfo.php`	Requires `?setcode=`. Returns card identifier, rarity, and pricing for a specific print set.
GET	`/archetypes.php`	Returns a list of all official card archetype names stored in the database.
GET	`/checkDBVer.php`	Returns real-time database version and last update timestamp. Never cached.

2. PRIMARY FILTER PARAMETERS (/CARDINFO.PHP)

PARAMETER	ACCEPTED TYPES	DESCRIPTION & SYNTAX
`name`	String (Pipe-separated)	Exact card name match. Multi-value: `Baby Dragon|Time Wizard`. Cannot combine with `id`.
`fname`	String	Fuzzy search matching any substring across card names (e.g. `fname=Magician`).
`id` / `konami_id`	Integer (Comma-separated)	Passcode (8-digit ID) or official Konami ID. Multi-id: `46986414,6983839`.
`type`	String (Comma-separated)	Monster, Spell, Trap card classification (e.g. `Spell Card,Synchro Monster`).
`atk` / `def` / `level`	Int / Comparison	Supports numeric values or operators: `lt`, `lte`, `gt`, `gte` (e.g. `atk=gte2500`).
`race` / `attribute`	String (Comma-separated)	Monster typing (e.g. `Dragon`, `Spellcaster`) or Spell/Trap type (`Equip`, `Counter`).

3. ADVANCED FILTERING & MECHANICS

The `cardinfo.php` endpoint incorporates specialized gameplay attributes, Link arrows, and format legalities:

PARAMETER	ACCEPTED VALUES	OPERATIONAL USAGE
`link` / `linkmarker`	Int / Comma-separated	Filter Link rating (e.g. `link=4`) and arrow directions (`Top,Bottom,Left,Right,Bottom-Left...`).
`scale`	Integer	Pendulum scale numeric value (0 through 13).
`cardset`	String	Pack or box name (e.g. `Metal Raiders`, `Soul Fusion`, `Duel Devastator`).
`archetype`	String	Archetype group (e.g. `Blue-Eyes`, `Dark Magician`, `HERO`, `Prank-Kids`).
`banlist`	`tcg`, `ocg`, `goat`	Filters cards currently restricted on the chosen format banlist.
`format`	Format string	`tcg`, `goat`, `ocg goat`, `speed duel`, `master duel`, `rush duel`, `genesys`.
`sort`	Sort string	Orders response list by: `atk`, `def`, `name`, `type`, `level`, `id`, `new`.
`has_effect`	`true` / `false`	Identifies non-effect monsters across Normal and Extra Deck cards (e.g. *Black Skull Dragon*).
`staple`	`yes`	Limits queries strictly to community-recognized staple competitive cards.
`startdate` / `enddate`	`YYYY-MM-DD`	Date boundaries. Paired with `dateregion=tcg` (default) or `dateregion=ocg`.
`misc`	`yes`	Appends extended metadata: views, release dates, Master Duel rarity, alternate names.

4. COMPARATIVE OPERATORS & FORMAT DEFINITIONS

Numeric Stat Comparisons

Prefix field parameters with relational tokens:

- `lt` — Less Than: `atk=lt2500`
- `lte` — Less Than or Equal: `level=lte4`
- `gt` — Greater Than: `def=gt2000`
- `gte` — Greater Than or Equal: `atk=gte3000`

Format Legalities

Format-specific query behaviors:

- `format=tcg` — Excludes Speed & Rush Duel cards without TCG releases.
- `format=genesys` — Appends `genesys_points` in response.
- `format=genesys ocg` — Appends `genesys_ocg_points` in response.
- `format=master duel` — Provides Master Duel legal pool.

Null Value Rule: If an attribute is not applicable to the card category (for instance, `def`, `level`, or `scale` on a Link Monster), the corresponding key is completely omitted from the JSON payload rather than set to `null`.

5. SCHEMA & PAYLOAD STRUCTURE

Card lookups return an array of card objects wrapped inside a top-level `data` attribute:

FIELD KEY	TYPE	CONTENT DESCRIPTION
`id` / `name`	Integer / String	Unique card passcode and canonical English printing name.
`type` / `frameType`	String	Game categorization (e.g. `XYZ Monster`) and card border style (`xyz`, `spell`).
`card_sets`	Array of Objects	Contains `set_name`, `set_code`, `set_rarity`, and estimated `set_price`.
`card_images`	Array of Objects	Image variants with `image_url`, `image_url_small`, and `image_url_cropped`.
`card_prices`	Array of Objects	Aggregated market minimums: `cardmarket_price`, `tcgplayer_price`, `ebay_price`, etc.
`misc_info` (optional)	Array of Objects	Enabled via `misc=yes`: release dates, view metrics, `konami_id`, and format points.

6. EXAMPLE JSON RESPONSE PAYLOAD


```
{
  "data": [
    {
      "id": 6983839,
      "name": "Tornado Dragon",
      "type": "XYZ Monster",
      "frameType": "xyz",
      "desc": "2 Level 4 monsters\nOnce per turn (Quick Effect): You can detach 1 material...",
      "atk": 2100,
      "def": 2000,
      "level": 4,
      "race": "Wyrm",
      "attribute": "WIND",
      "card_sets": [
        { "set_name": "Maximum Crisis", "set_code": "MACR-EN081", "set_rarity": "Secret Rare", "set_price":
      ],
      "card_images": [
        { "id": 6983839, "image_url": "https://images.ygoprodeck.com/images/cards/6983839.jpg" }
      ],
      "card_prices": [
        { "cardmarket_price": "0.42", "tcgplayer_price": "0.48", "ebay_price": "2.99" }
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```


7. QUERY QUICK-START EXAMPLES

- **Fuzzy Monster Lookup:** `https://db.ygoprodeck.com/api/v7/cardinfo.php?fname=Wizard&attribute=light&race=spellcaster`
- **Rank 4 Water Monsters ordered by ATK:** `https://db.ygoprodeck.com/api/v7/cardinfo.php?level=4&attribute=water&sort=atk`
- **Archetype Search:** `https://db.ygoprodeck.com/api/v7/cardinfo.php?archetype=Blue-Eyes`
- **TCG Banlist Level 4 Alphabetical:** `https://db.ygoprodeck.com/api/v7/cardinfo.php?banlist=tcg&level=4&sort=name`
- **Link Monsters with Top & Bottom Markers:** `https://db.ygoprodeck.com/api/v7/cardinfo.php?type=Link%20Monster&linkmarker=top,bottom`